

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 23, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 7:17–24

17 But as God has distributed to each one, as the Lord has called each one, so let him walk. And so I ordain in all the churches.

18 Was anyone called while circumcised? Let him not become uncircumcised. Was anyone called while uncircumcised? Let him not be circumcised.

19 Circumcision is nothing and uncircumcision is nothing, but keeping the commandments of God is what matters.

20 Let each one remain in the same calling in which he was called.

21 Were you called while a slave? Do not be concerned about it; but if you can be made free, rather use it.

22 For he who is called in the Lord while a slave is the Lord's freedman. Likewise he who is called while free is Christ's slave.

23 You were bought at a price; do not become slaves of men.

24 Brethren, let each one remain with God in that state in which he was called.

II. Key Summary

- Paul lays down one rule for every church: wherever God called you, keep walking there — don't wait for your circumstances to improve before living out your faith.
 - External identity — circumcised or not, slave or free — does not determine your value before God; what matters is keeping His commandments.
 - "You were bought at a price" — your true identity comes from what Christ paid, not from the labels others put on you.
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III. Passage Analysis

Where You Are Is Already Enough

"The rules of Christianity reach every condition; and in every state a man may live so as to be a credit to it." [1]

Paul's instruction to "remain in the same calling" isn't telling people to give up on change — it's saying your current situation is already a place where God can work. You don't have to get your life sorted out before you can follow Jesus for real.

You're Not Defined by What Others Say

"Do not become slaves of men. This is true not only in regard to literal slavery, but spiritually also. We are never to put ourselves under the inappropriate control or influence of others." [2]

"You were bought at a price" — your real owner is only one. People's opinions, friends' judgments, family expectations — you can listen to them, but they can't be the foundation of who you are. Someone already paid an enormous price to define you differently.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever caught yourself thinking, "I'll take my faith more seriously once things settle down" — after exams, after that friendship gets fixed, after home stops feeling chaotic?

If God is already present in exactly the place you're at right now, what do you think that means?

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Matthew Henry Commentary,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/7-17.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-7/>